

A PAYMENT GIANT

FOUNDING YEAR	2014
> Co-founders	Harshil Mathur, Shashank Kumar
> Unicorn year	2020
> Last funding raised	2021, Series F
> Last funding amount	₹2,850 cr
> Key investors	Tiger Global Management, Peak XV Partners, Y Combinator
> Number of transactions processes	One billion every quarter
> Total payment volume	\$180 billion
> Revenue in FY25	₹3,932 cr
> Profit/Loss in FY25	(-) ₹1,206 cr
> IPO	Expected by end of 2026

because several large banks and consumer apps were not even on the platform. But we believed it represented the future of digital payments. When UPI eventually took off, many large customers moved to Razorpay because we were already ready. Being early on those bets has helped us create long-term value for our customers, and that is ultimately what matters more than valuation.

Q. Your name now features on wealth rankings, but you have often spoken more about impact than valuation. On a personal level, how do you define success and what does wealth mean to you today?

A. Success means different things at different stages of life. Today, I measure it by the impact on people and on the ecosystem. Whether it is the number of start-ups we have helped build, the customers who genuinely feel they will miss us if Razorpay did not exist, or the employees who have grown with the

company—that is what success looks like to me.

It is not just about giving people jobs. They could have found jobs elsewhere. The real question is whether they were able to do meaningful work, learn something new and grow because they were at Razorpay. That is what gives me the greatest sense of satisfaction.

Even employees who have moved on often tell us that Razorpay was the most meaningful phase of their careers because they got to do some of their best work here. Those are the moments that make you proud.

As for wealth, of course it is important. I won't pretend it is not. But I see it as a means to an end rather than the end itself. It gives you the ability to take care of your family, support causes you care about and create opportunities that may not have been possible otherwise.

For example, my father is deeply passionate about philanthropy. He comes from a small village, and he enjoys giving back to his community.

Personally, though, I don't spend much time thinking about wealth. Building a company takes up almost all your time. By the time Sunday comes around, I would rather spend it quietly with my family and friends than think about material things.

Q. India's digital payments ecosystem has evolved dramatically over the past decade, driven by UPI and a strong public digital infrastructure. How important have these digital public rails been in Razorpay growth and shaping India's fintech ecosystem?

A. I think India's public digital infrastructure is among the best in the world. What is unique is that we have created public rails on top of which private companies can build the last-mile experience. That means everyone benefits as the ecosystem grows, instead of operating in closed-loop systems.

A large part of the success of India's fintech ecosystem—including Razorpay—has been possible because of these digital public rails and the way they have been designed. It has been a collective effort. Policymakers, the government, regulators, public institutions and private companies like us, as well as consumer-facing fintech players, have all played an important role in building the ecosystem we have today. **BT**

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